

ery seventh car sold in India is made by Tata Motors, a feat that has helped it achieve the 5-million mark.

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BETWEEN 2006 AND 2016, Tata Motors's PV portfolio faced a double whammy. On the one hand, its three models on the Indica platform—Indigo, Marina, and Indigo CS—faced intense competition. And on the other, Indica and Indigo's move into the fleet segment caused positioning dissonance with personal car buyers, as Tata Motors found itself in the middle of a major identity crisis.

Enter Guenter Butschek, who joined the trouble-hit carmaker in 2016. For the Airbus veteran, the challenge was to reinvent Tata Motors as a leader in a rapidly evolving transportation world, while simultaneously delivering profits. He brought his learnings from the aeronautical industry and introduced six relevant “angles of attack”: top-line cost reduction, improvement of core processes, customer centricity, new technologies, business models and partnerships, and a lean and accountable organisation. (The ‘angle of attack’ is the angle between the oncoming air and the aircraft wing, which is crucial in facilitating the lift of an aircraft). By the time he stepped down in June 2021, Tata Motors was ready to challenge Hyundai.

“What has worked for us in the past two and a half years is that we came with a portfolio of products which were pretty much in the [PV] segments that were in the sweet spot of growth [in India]. We came with cars that were more stylish and expressive with best-in-class safety and reliability. Our expansion in [monthly] production capacity from 11,000 cars to 45,000 cars also helped,” says Chandra, adding that by the end of 2023, the company is aiming for a monthly capacity of 50,000 units for all PV plants. “The new Sanand plant will further help with a capacity of 300,000 per annum, which is yet to be operationalised,” he says.

At present, the company has a capacity of 480,000 units across multiple plants. In the first nine months (April-December 2022) of FY23, Tata Motors produced 409,173 passenger vehicles compared to 248,600 a year ago.

The company's turnaround also involved struc-



PHOTO BY MILIND SHELTE

“THE NEXT 5 MILLION IS GOING TO BE MUCH FASTER AND VERY DIFFERENT FROM THE PREVIOUS 5 MILLION... THIS JOURNEY WILL BE DRIVEN BY MORE ELECTRIC CARS”

SHAILESH CHANDRA

MD, TATA MOTORS PASSENGER VEHICLES AND
TATA PASSENGER ELECTRIC MOBILITY